



Shifting from Google Docs to Microsoft Word:

A College Student's Guide

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ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

Many thanks to the people who contributed to the creation of this manual. This includes classmates of mine involved in the drafting process. Special thanks to Professor Janine Solberg for the continuous feedback and advice given to me throughout the entire semester.

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INTRODUCTION

Throughout the typical semester, a college student generates countless pages of writing. Multiple online writing programs have emerged which allow students to write on their devices. Out of these programs, **Google Docs** is an increasingly popular program among students due to its simplicity.

Why use Microsoft Word?

Despite preferences, you may find yourself forced to use **Microsoft Word**. Certain professors or classes might necessitate you to make a sudden jump from your preferred program. For those already familiar with Google Docs, this transition can feel uncomfortable or even annoying at first.

This manual seeks to **bridge that gap** and guide students already familiar with Google Docs and ease their transition into using Microsoft Word (365) for the desktop application on Windows devices.

What the manual covers

While it's true that Microsoft Word shares many of the same functions as Google Docs, they may look or behave slightly differently. In this manual, each chapter guides you through basic functions.

Some (but not all) of the contents in this manual address essential functions in Microsoft Word which the average college student might find useful, such as:

- Creating and customizing new documents
- Generating citations within pages
- Sharing documents with other people

Through these chapters, this manual seeks to establish a more comfortable and streamlined experience using Microsoft Word.

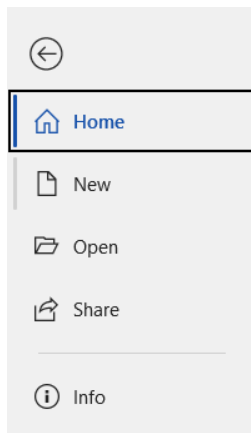
CHAPTER 1:

CREATING DOCUMENTS

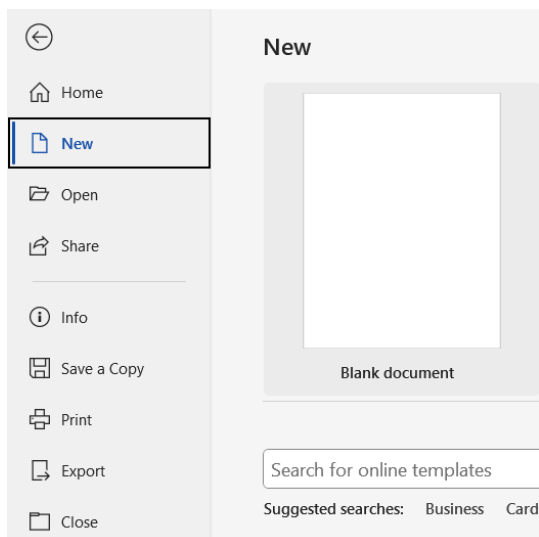
1.1 Starting a new blank document

Creating a blank document is the crucial first step in starting your work in any writing application. In Word, the process is like Docs. A blank document can also be customized to suit all types of documentation a student could wish to write.

1. Open Microsoft Word.
2. Click on the **File** tab in the top-left corner.
3. Select **New** from the menu.



4. Click on **Blank document** (alternatively, press **Shift + N** to immediately open a new blank document).



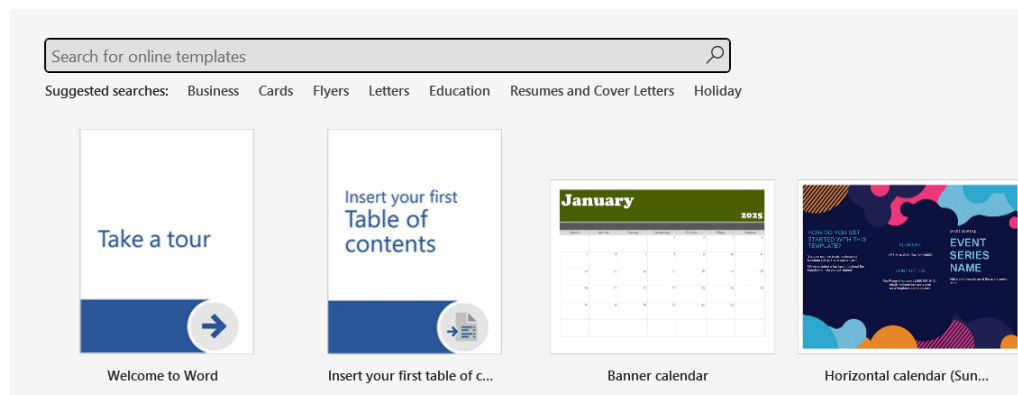
Your new document opens and is ready to be edited.

1.2 Creating a new document from a template

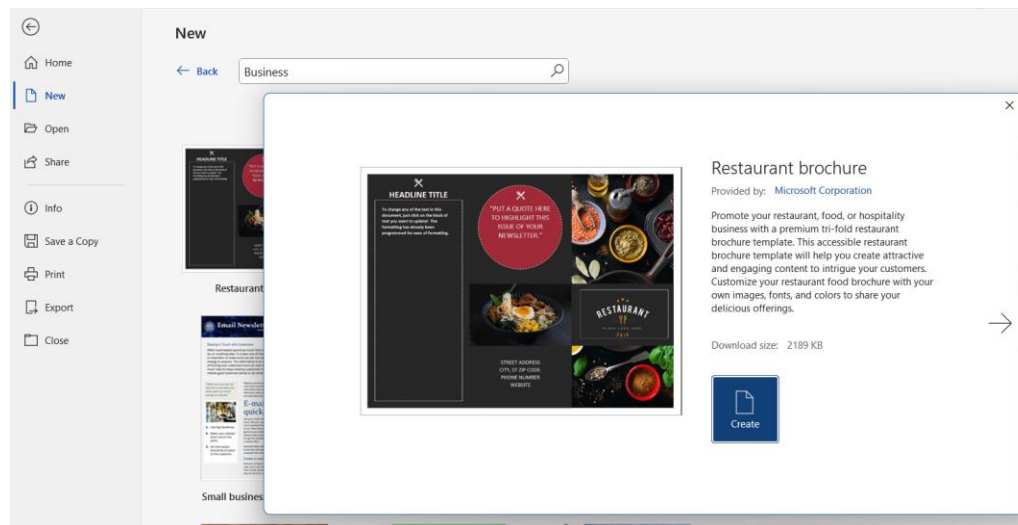
Word offers multiple templates which vary in purpose and style, which can help organization or meet certain formatting guidelines. Word templates can help you save time by using a pre-formatted composition for various academic documents.

1. Click the **File** tab.
2. Select **New**.
3. Browse the featured templates.

Alternatively, type into the search box to find a specific template or click on **Suggested searches** to find recommended templates.



4. Select a template.
This opens a preview.



5. Click **Create**.

CHAPTER 2:

CREATING LISTS

2.1 Creating a bullet, number, and multi-level lists

Online writing applications like Word or Docs are most often used when writing notes for classes. You can use a bullet list (unordered list) when the sequence of items is not important or a numbered list (ordered list) when the order is crucial, such as for steps. You can use multilevel lists to break down large projects into smaller, more manageable tasks and subtasks.

Create a bullet list (unordered list):

1. Type an asterisk (*) followed by a space at the beginning of a line.
2. Type the first list item and press **Enter** to add the next item automatically. To exit the list, press **Enter** twice.

Create a numbered list (ordered list)

1. Type the number **1**, a period (.), followed by a space at the beginning of a line.
2. Type the first list item and press **Enter** to add the next item automatically. To exit the list, press **Enter** twice.

Create a multi-level list:

1. Create a bullet or numbered list as described above.
2. Press the **Tab** key to create a sub item.
3. Press **Shift + Tab** to go back to the previous level.
By default, the multi-level begins with a lower-case letter (a) and follow the alphabet as more levels are added to the list.
To exit the list, press **Enter** three times.

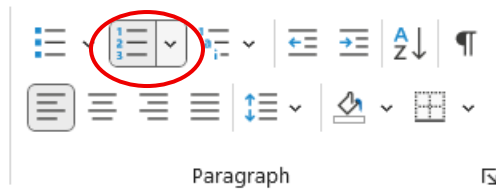
2.2 Changing list style:

You can select different styles of lists, which can suit certain aesthetic choices or preferences. For example, instead of numbers, you can change a list to use letters.

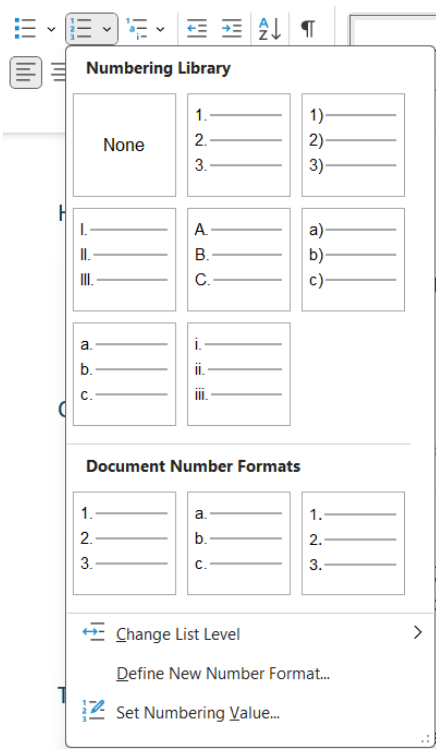
1. Look for the **Bullets** or **Numbering** icons in the **Paragraph** section from the ribbon.



2. Click the arrow next to the **Bullets** or **Numbering** button.



3. Select a new style from the menu that appears.



The selected list now follows the format selected.

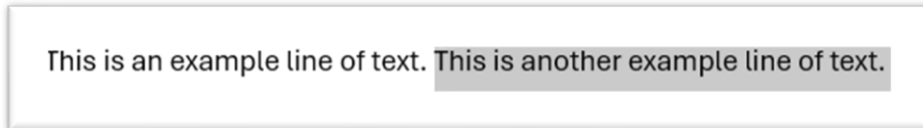
CHAPTER 3:

CUSTOMIZING FONTS

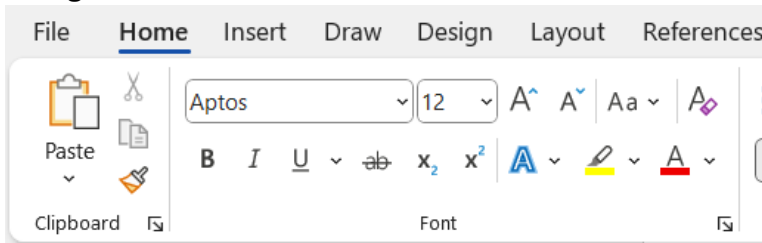
3.1 Changing the default font

Font styles are a necessary aspect to understand when using an online writing program like Microsoft Word or Google Docs. By default, Word uses Aptos font, but there are multiple ways to change this while editing a document.

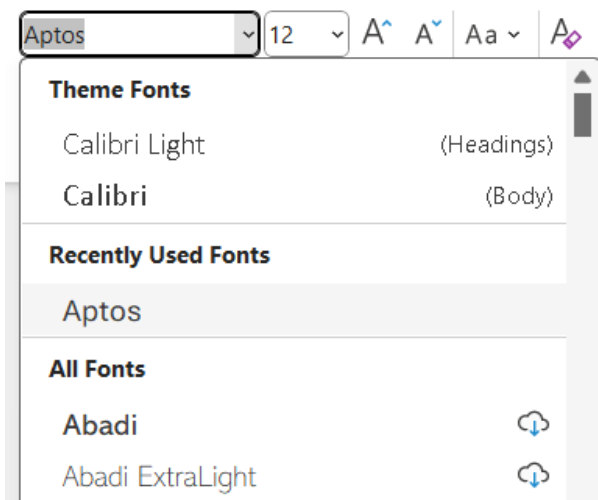
1. Select the text.



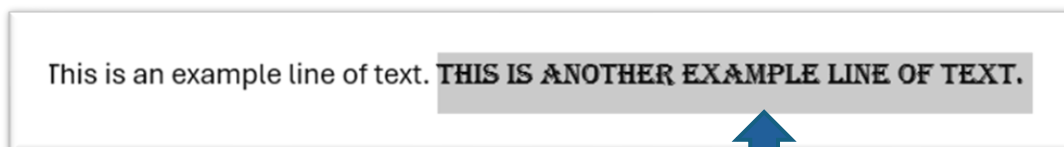
2. Navigate to the **Home** tab and look for the **Font** section in the ribbon.



3. Click the dropdown arrow by the font name.



4. Choose a new font from the menu.

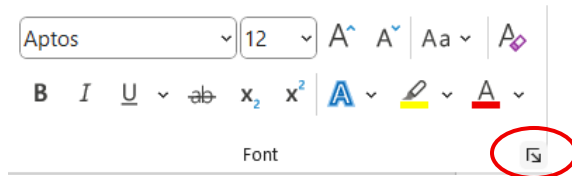


This example uses Algerian typeface.

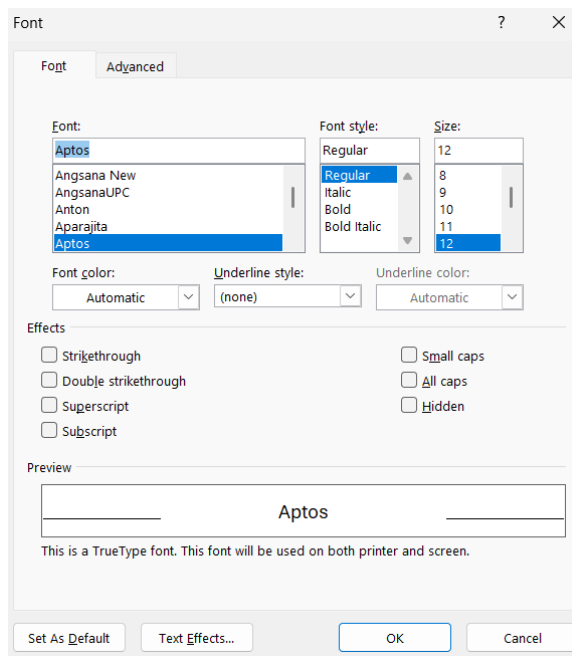
3.2 Changing the default font for all new documents

You can set up Word so that a new document always uses a specific font of your choice. You might find this is more convenient than constantly changing the font after creating the blank document.

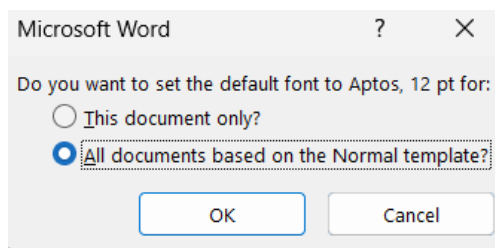
1. Navigate to the **Home** tab and look for the **Font** section in the ribbon.



2. Click the small arrow in the bottom-right corner of the Font group to open the Font dialog box (alternatively, press **Ctrl + D**).
3. After adjusting the font as desired, click **Set As Default** in the bottom-left corner. This opens a new window.



4. Select **All documents based on the Normal template** and click **OK**.



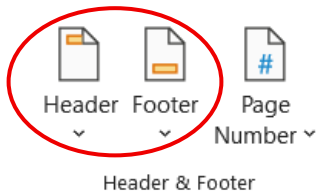
CHAPTER 4:

CUSTOMIZATING PAGES

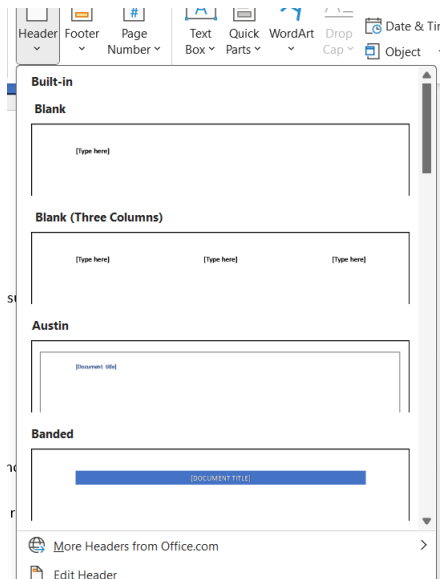
4.1 Adding headers and footers

Headers and footers serve similar purposes in both Word and Google Docs. They can provide information like page numbers, document titles, and author details which help organize the document.

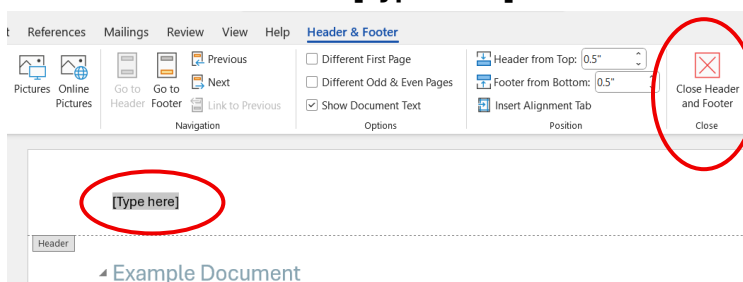
1. Navigate to the **Insert** tab and look for the **Header & Footer** section in the ribbon.
2. Click **Header** or **Footer**.



3. Click on a style or select **Blank** to create a custom header or footer.
This opens the header and footer editing tools.



4. Enter text in the selected **[Type here]** area.



5. When you are finished, click **Close Header and Footer** in the ribbon (alternatively, press the **Esc** key).

4.2 Changing the text alignment

Alignment of text is crucial when formatting a document in an online word program like Word or Google Docs. It not only structures content but enhances readability through organization.

1. Select the text.
2. Navigate to the **Home** tab and look for the **Paragraph** section in the ribbon.
3. Select one of the four alignment options.



Keyboard shortcuts:

Ctrl + L to Align Left

Ctrl + E to Center

Ctrl + R to Align Right

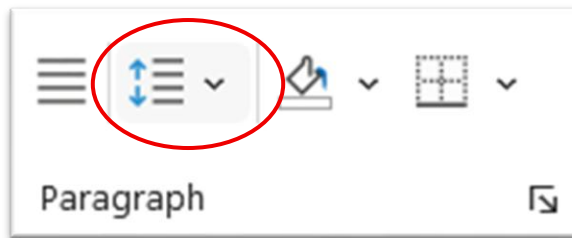
Ctrl + J to Justify

- **Align Left:** Aligns text to the left margin.
Commonly used for essays and academic writing.
- **Center:** Centers text between the left and right margins.
Often used for titles and headings.
- **Align Right:** Aligns text to the right margin.
Mostly used for small sections of content, such as text in a header or footer.
- **Justify:** Creates even left and right edges by adjusting spacing between words.
Sometimes used for lengthy blocks of text to create a more organized and professional look.

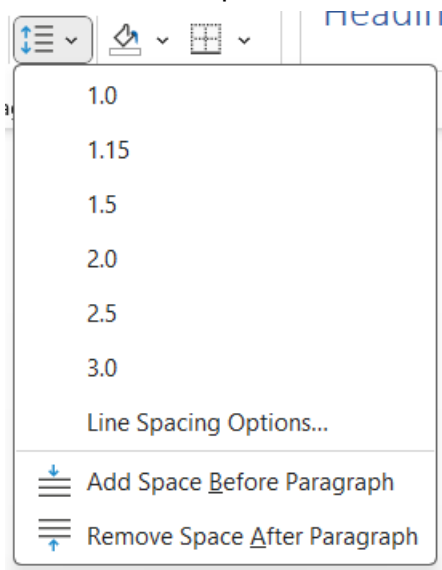
4.3 Adjusting the line spacing

Line spacing is an important aspect of organizing a document. Essays often require double spacing while other assignments might demand different line spacing.

1. Select the text.
2. Navigate to the **Home** tab and look for the **Paragraph** section in the ribbon.
3. Look for the **Line and Paragraph Spacing** icon.



4. Click on the dropdown menu.



5. Select the spacing you want to use.
6. Optionally, for more detailed options, choose **Line Spacing Options** to adjust spacing before and after the paragraph, as well as between lines.

CHAPTER 5:

CREATING SOURCES

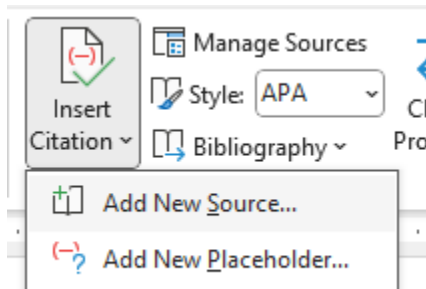
5.1 Creating a source

Sources are often a necessity when writing academic writing. Word has a function to insert a citation into the document.

1. Place the cursor where you want the citation to appear in your document.
2. Navigate to the **References** tab and look for the **Citations & Bibliography** section in the ribbon.



3. Click the **Insert Citation** button and select **Add New Source**.



4. In the Create Source dialog box, choose the **Type of Source** from the provided list.

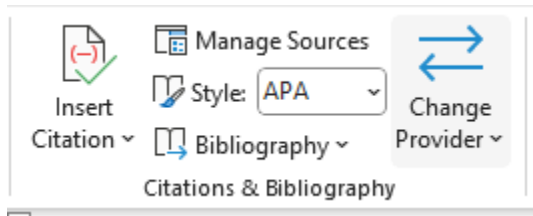
A screenshot of the 'Create Source' dialog box in Microsoft Word. The 'Type of Source' dropdown menu is open, showing a list of source types: 'Book', 'Book Section', 'Journal Article', 'Article in a Periodical', 'Conference Proceedings', and 'Report'. The 'Book' option is selected. Below the dropdown, there are input fields for 'Author', 'Title', 'Year', 'City', and 'Publisher'. There is also a checkbox labeled 'Show All Bibliography Fields' and a 'Tag name' field with 'Placeholder1' entered. At the bottom right, there are 'OK' and 'Cancel' buttons.

5. Fill in the required fields with the source information, such as the Author, Title, Year, and Publisher. Optionally, click **Show All Bibliography Fields** to see and add more detailed information.
6. Click **OK** to insert the citation into your document.

5.2 Inserting a bibliography

As a college student, you are typically expected to reference multiple sources when writing research projects. Bibliographies are an organized list of sources usually at the end of research projects. The bibliography function in Word automatically organizes citations already inserted into your document.

1. Click where you want the bibliography to appear in your document (typically at the end).
2. Navigate to the **References** tab and look for the **Citations & Bibliography** section in the ribbon.



3. Click the **Bibliography** tab.



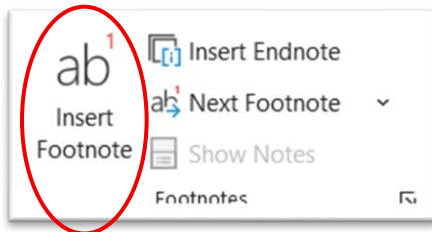
4. Choose an option from the dropdown menu, such as **Bibliography**, **References**, or **Works Cited**.

Word creates a list of all your cited sources.

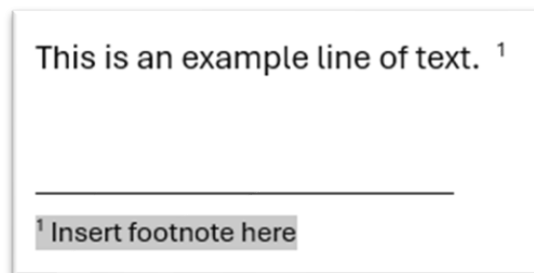
5.3 Inserting a footnote

Footnotes are an efficient and seamless way of crediting a source within a document. It can also be used to provide contextual information or additional information without disrupting the main text.

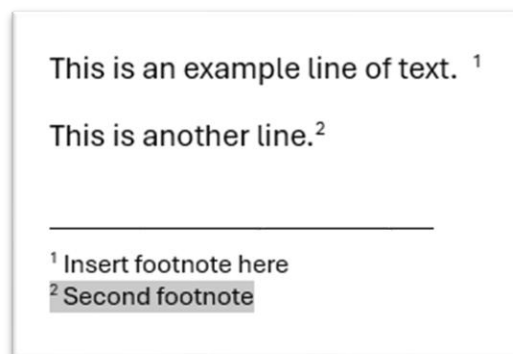
1. Click in the document where you want the footnote to appear.
2. Navigate to the **References** tab and look for the **Footnotes** section.



3. Click **Insert Footnote** (alternatively, press **Alt + Ctrl + F**). Word automatically adds a numbered reference mark (a superscript) into the text and place your cursor at the bottom of the current page.



4. Type your footnote text.
5. Optionally, add as many footnotes as desired. Word automatically keeps track of how many footnotes are on a page.



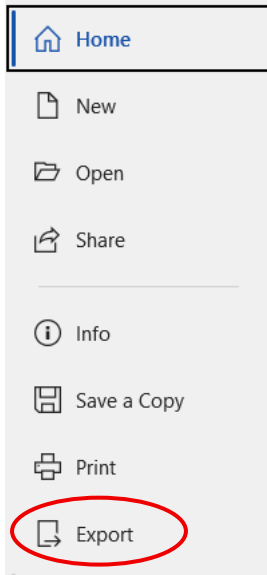
CHAPTER 6:

SHARING DOCUMENTS

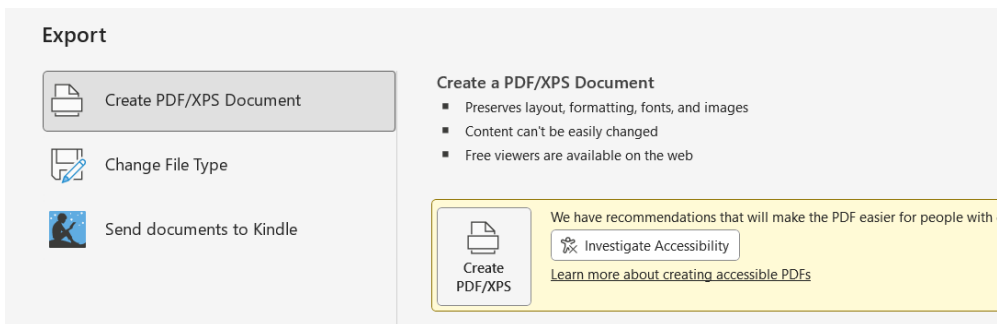
6.1 Exporting a document

As a college student, you often need to export documents, such as when submitting assignments or saving files to different formats. PDFs are a common file type students export as, which preserves the document in a universally compatible format.

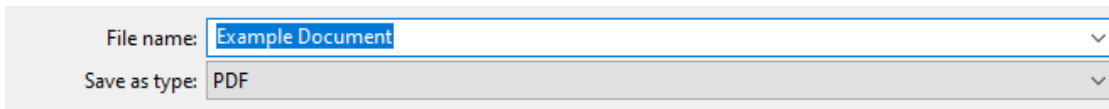
1. Open the document in Microsoft Word.
2. Click the **File** tab in the top-left corner.
3. Select **Export** from the menu.



4. Choose the option to create a **PDF/XPS** document.



This opens a window, where the document can be renamed or the file type can be changed.

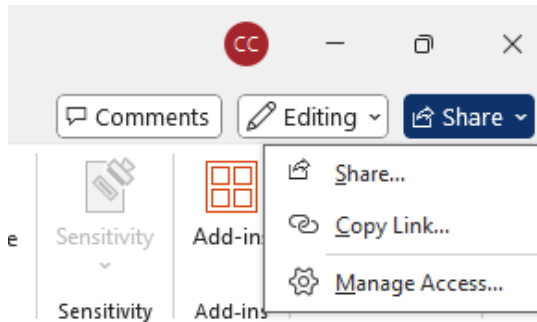


5. Click **Publish**.

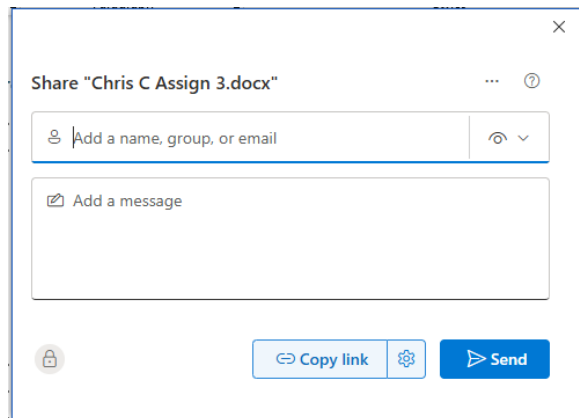
6.2 Sharing a document

Students often share documents with each other when working on group assignments.

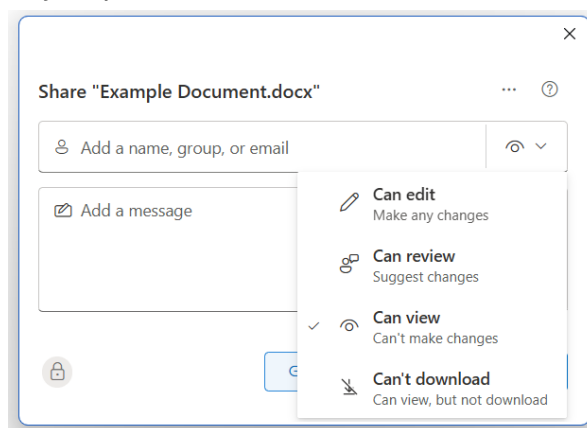
1. Open the document.
2. Click **Share** from the top-right of the document.



3. Click **Share** from the drop-down menu.



4. Type names or email addresses to share the document with other people.
5. Adjust permissions as desired.

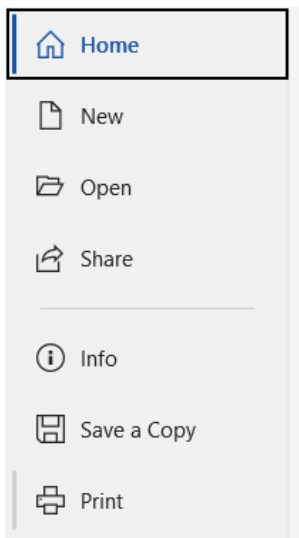


6. Press **Send**. Recipients receive an email with a link to the document.

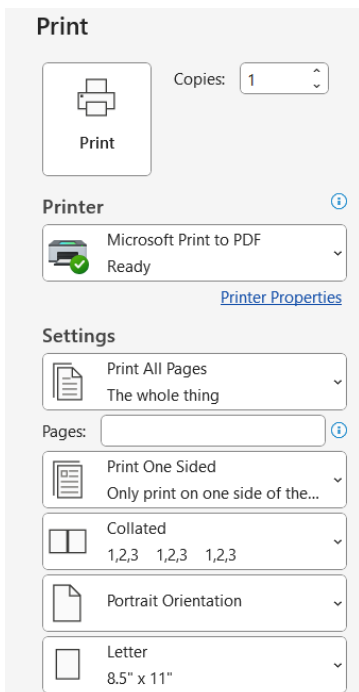
6.3 Printing a document

Printing documents is one of the more common methods of sharing a document with someone. As opposed to digital sharing, some professors might prefer you print out physical copies of your work.

1. Click the **File** tab.
2. Select **Print** from the menu.



3. Optimize your printing settings.



4. Click on the **Print** icon when satisfied.

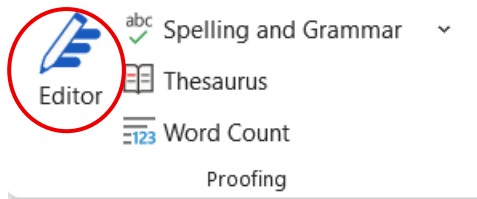
CHAPTER 7:

USING THE EDITOR TOOL

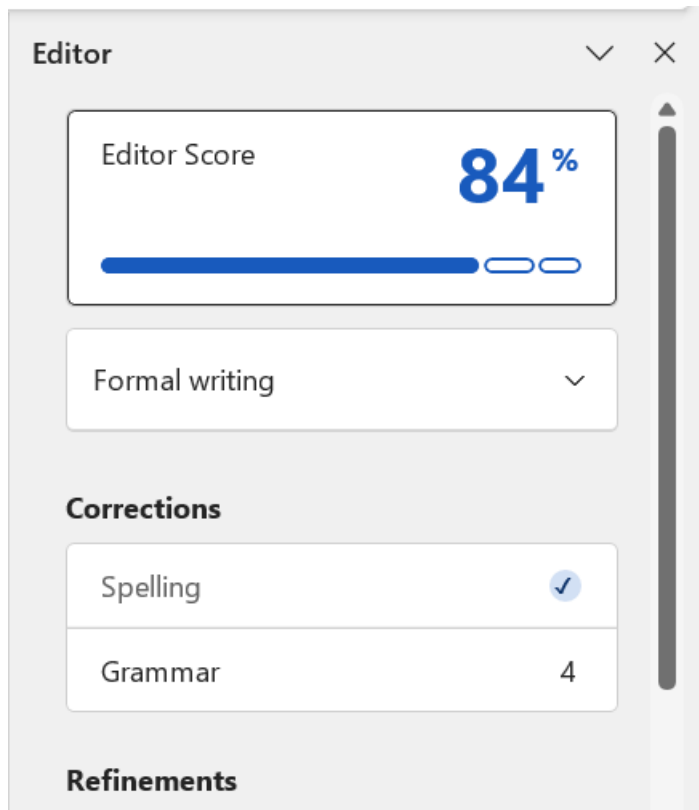
7.1 Locating the Editor Tool

Editor is a built-in tool of Word which assess a document's overall quality through factors such as spelling, grammar, and formality. Once opening the Editor tool, the most prominent aspect is the **Editor Score** which assigns a grade to your document based on what corrections the Editor suggests.

1. Navigate to the **Review** tab.
2. Locate the **Editor** tool in the **Proofing** section of the ribbon.



3. Click on the **Editor** icon (alternatively, press **F7** to open the Editor pane directly).



7.2 Navigating the Editor pane

The Editor tool can be a daunting task upon initial performance.

1. Scroll down from the Editor Score.

Corrections	
Spelling	
Grammar	4
Refinements	
Clarity	3
Conciseness	

2. Click on a category such as **Spelling** or **Clarity** to see specific issues (alternatively, click the editor score to start from your current cursor position).

Spelling

Not in Dictionary

This is an example of a spelling **correctiion**. 

Consider:

correction
alteration, improvement, rectification ...

corrector
[No reference information]

corrections
alterations, improvements, rectifications

 Ignore once

 Ignore all

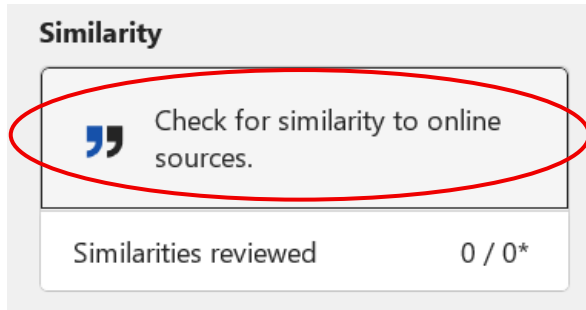
 Add to dictionary

3. Click the suggested change to apply it to your document (alternatively, ignore it to move to the next suggestion).

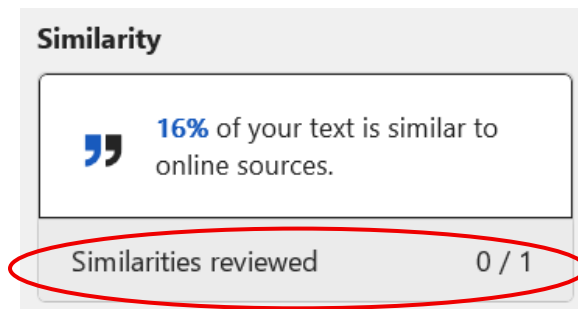
7.3 Using the Similarity checker in Editor

Plagiarism is a violation of academic integrity and should be avoided at all costs. The Editor tool has a built-in function which scans your document for text that matches online sources in its database. As an anti-plagiarism tool, Editor is an invaluable resource.

1. Scroll down to the **Similarity** section in the Editor pane.

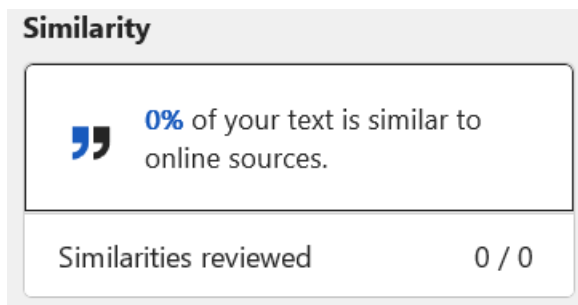


2. Click on **Check for similarity**.
3. Wait for the check to be completed, which shows a percentage of similar content and the number of passages to review.



4. Click **Similarities reviewed** to see the results.

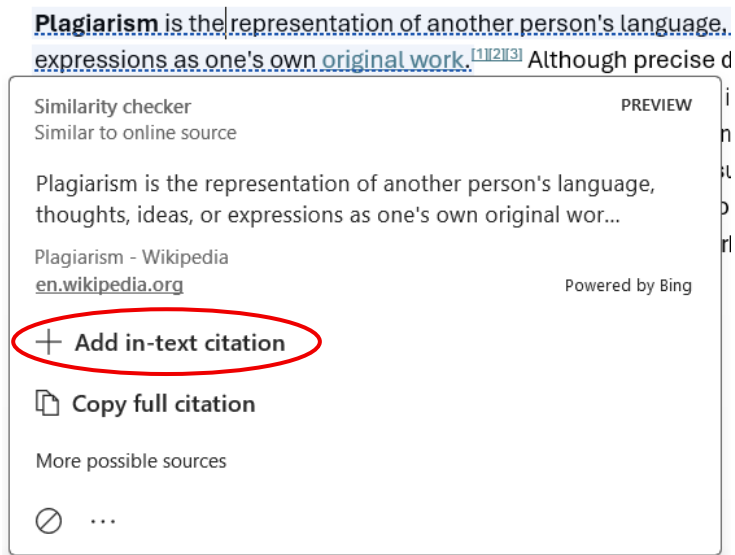
A document with no similarity to online sources shows the result below.



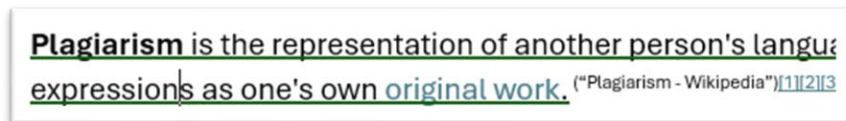
7.4 Using Editor to edit similar passages

If similarity is detected, editor underlines the specific section with a link to the original online source. **If similarity is detected in your document**, proceed with the following steps to avoid possible issues with plagiarism.

1. Click on the underlined passage to see the source and decide if a citation is necessary.



2. To add a citation, click the option to **Add in-text citation** (alternatively, if you don't need a citation for a particular passage, select the ignore icon)



Editor automatically adds the citation and quotation marks as needed.

COLOPHON

This manual was created in Microsoft Word (365). Many revisions to the manual were made throughout the drafting process with input from classmates and the class instructor, Janine Solberg.

This manual was largely influenced by class assignments and readings. These readings include works useful for technical writers and cover crucial factors to creating and drafting a cohesive manual. Especially helpful were readings covering document usability, what distinguishes technical writing from other forms of writing, and how the design of a manual affects readers' ability to interpret and use them. Authors of these readings include (but are not limited to) Tom Johnson, Chip and Dan Heath, Krista Van Laan, and Robin Williams.